

Prescribing Information
STADA Arzneimittel AG, D-61118 Bad Vilbel, Germany
Dear patient,
Please be sure to carefully read this Insert because it contains important information on how to use this medication effectively and safely. If you have any questions or concerns, please do not hesitate to ask your doctor or pharmacist.

Acyclovir 400 Stada®

Product Description

Round, White, biconvex tablets. Imprint: VS2

Composition

Each tablet contains:

Pharmacologically active ingredient:

Acyclovir, 400mg

Other ingredients:

Microcrystalline cellulose, copolyvidon, magnesium stearate, sodium starch glycolate, colloidal anhydrous silica

Presentation and contents

Original package of 35 tablets

Acyclovir 400 Stada® is an antiviral drug

Pharmacodynamics

Mode of Action

Acyclovir is a guanine derivative whose activity is essentially confined to viral thymidine kinase-producing human pathogenic herpes viruses, i.e. herpes simplex virus types 1 and 2 (HSV-1 and HSV-2), and varicella-zoster virus (VSV). Acyclovir is not pharmacologically active until it has been converted by viral thymidine kinase inside virally infected cells along the following pathway:

Phosphorylation of acyclovir (the substrate) to acyclovir monophosphate is faster by viral thymidine kinase than by host cell thymidine kinase. This relative selectivity minimizes the toxicity of acyclovir to host cells. Normal cellular nucleotidyl phosphotransferases then catalyse the sequential conversion of acyclovir monophosphate to acyclovir triphosphate.

Acyclovir triphosphate (the active form of the drug) selectively inhibits viral DNA polymerase and is incorporated into viral DNA. Acyclovir triphosphate competitively displaces deoxyguanosine triphosphate from DNA polymerases. Acyclovir triphosphate has higher affinity for HSV-encoded DNA polymerase than cellular DNA polymerase (10 to 20 times greater). It acts as a substrate for HSV-encoded DNA polymerase and, cleaving off diphosphate is incorporated into viral DNA. However, as acyclovir lacks a 3'-hydroxyl group, nucleotides can no longer be added by 3',5'-linkage, causing chain termination. Moreover, the DNA-viral polymerase complex remain intact, inactivating the enzyme. Acyclovir activity is greatest against HSV-1 and HSV-2 because these depend on their own thymidine kinase for replication. Acyclovir is also a substrate for VSV-encoded thymidine kinase, but the concentrations required for anti-VSV activity are higher. Acyclovir also inhibits EBV DNA polymerase. Toxicity to the host cell is low because of the drug's affinity for viral enzymes. Acyclovir is also active against Epstein-Barr virus (EBV), cytomegalovirus (CMV) and other herpes viruses (varicella-like simian virus, DHV 1, neurotropic and tumour viruses, pseudorabies virus, PDV) but to a lesser extent and a different mechanism of action may be involved.

Pharmacokinetics

Only part of an [oral] acyclovir dose is absorbed from the gastro-intestinal tract. The mean peak plasma concentrations at steady state following repeated oral administration of 200mg, 400mg or 800mg of acyclovir 5 times daily every 4 hours [during the day] were 3.02 ± 0.5µmol/l (200mg), 5.21 ± 1.32µmol/l (400mg) or 8.16 ± 1.98µmol/l (800mg). These values were attained after about 1.5 ± 0.6 hours. Plasma trough levels (determined about 4 hours after the last oral acyclovir dose) were 1.61 ± 0.3 µmol/l (200mg), 2.59 ± 0.53 µmol/l (400mg), or 4.0 ± 0.72 µmol/l (800mg). No drug was detectable in the body 24 hours after stopping acyclovir tablets.

Immunocompromised (3 to 11-year-old) children received 400mg of oral acyclovir (equivalent to 300-650mg of acyclovir/m²) 5 times daily and showed mean peak plasma concentrations of 5.7-15.1 µmol/l infants (1-6 weeks old) were administered 600mg of acyclovir/m² every 6 hours and had peak plasma concentrations of 17.3 or 8.6µmol/l. The biexponential kinetics of acyclovir suggest that the drug attains high concentrations in tissues and organs and is eliminated from these at a slow rate. The volume of distribution at steady state was 50 ± 1/1.73 m² in adults and 28.8 ± 9.3 l/1.73 m² in neonates and infants up to 3 months old. Protein binding ranged between 9 and 33%.

Indications

Shingles (herpes zoster).

Prevention of severe cases of herpes simplex infection in severely immunocompromised adult patients exposed to an elevated risk of infection, for example following organ transplants.

Contraindications

When should you not take Acyclovir 400 Stada® ?

You must not take Acyclovir 400 Stada® if you know you are hypersensitive to acyclovir or any other ingredient of Acyclovir 400 Stada®

If your kidney function is impaired or your urinary output is reduced to less than 100 ml of urine per 24 hours, you should not use Acyclovir 400 Stada® for prevention because no data available on the use of Acyclovir 400 Stada® in these conditions.

What should you be aware of if you are pregnant or breast-feeding?

The treating doctor will have to carefully weigh expected benefits against potential risks in pregnant women in whom Acyclovir 400 Stada® therapy proves necessary.

Acyclovir has been detected in breast milk following administration of acyclovir products. Breast-feeding is therefore discouraged while taking Acyclovir 400 Stada®.

What should you be aware of if you are elderly?

Elderly patients are more likely to have impaired kidney function than are younger people.

Elderly patients, therefore, are recommended to have their kidney function checked and ensure an adequate fluid intake while taking Acyclovir 400 Stada® tablets.

Also, the treating doctor may want to adjust your dosage (see "Dosage and Administration, duration of therapy").

Precautions for use and warnings

What should you be aware of?

See "Contraindications" and "Dosage and administration, duration of therapy".

Interactions with other drugs

What other medicines are known to interfere with the effects of Acyclovir 400 Stada® ?

Probenecid (uricosuric drug for gout) reduces acyclovir excretion via the kidneys, which may increase acyclovir persistence in the body.

Please bear in mind that these interactions may also apply to recently used medicines.

Dosage and administration, duration of therapy

The instructions given below apply unless your doctor has prescribed Acyclovir 400 Stada® otherwise for you.

Please comply with these and/or your doctor's instructions for effective and safe Acyclovir 400 Stada® therapy.

How many tablets and how often should you take Acyclovir 400 Stada® ?

Recommended dosage:

Adults:

Shingles (herpes zoster): Take 2 tablets (800mg) of acyclovir 5 times daily every 4 hours during the day.

Prevention of herpes simplex virus infection in certain circumstances:

One tablet (400 mg) of acyclovir can be taken 4 times daily every 6 hours for prevention of severe cases of herpes simplex infection in severely immunocompromised patients exposed to an elevated risk of infection, for example following organ transplants.

Patients with impaired kidney function:

(see "Contraindication"). Patients with kidney function impairment, which is particularly prevalent in elderly patients, may need a lower acyclovir dose than indicated above. If you should have kidney problems, your doctor will adjust your dosage to reflect your kidney function (see below).

Indication	Creatinine clearance	Serum creatinine (µmol/l) respectively (mg/dl)		Dosage
		Women	Men	
Herpes zoster	25 – 10	280-550/ 3.17-6.22	370-750/ 4.18-8.48	2 tablets (800 mg of acyclovir) 3 times daily (every 8 hours)
	<10	>550/ >6.22	>750/ >8.48	2 tablets (800 mg of acyclovir) twice daily (every 12 hours)

How and when should you take Acyclovir 400 Stada® ?

Swallow the tablets whole with a sufficient amount of liquid (eg a glass of water) after meals. An adequate fluid intake must be ensured during Acyclovir 400 Stada® therapy, especially in patients with impaired kidney function.

Please note:

For best response, Acyclovir 400 Stada® therapy should be started as early as possible, ie as soon as you notice the first signs on your skin.

For how long should you take Acyclovir 400 Stada® ?

Your doctor will determine for how long you should continue Acyclovir 400 Stada® therapy.

The duration of therapy of herpes zoster is 7 days. The length of prophylaxis of severe herpes simplex virus infection will depend on the severity of immunocompromise and will be determined by the treating doctor specifically for you.

Violations of dosing schedule and overdose action

What should you do in the event of a (deliberate or inadvertent) Acyclovir 400 Stada® overdose?

Intoxication is unlikely after an Acyclovir 400 Stada® overdose. A single dose of 5 g of acyclovir produced no signs or symptoms of intoxication. However, no data are available for higher single (over) doses.

If you suspect an overdose, should experience pronounced side effects or are in doubt, be sure to discuss with your doctor any concerns you may have.

Treatment of overdose

Acyclovir is effectively eliminated by haemodialysis.

What should you do if you took less than the prescribed dose of Acyclovir 400 Stada® or missed dose?

Continue therapy as prescribed (so do not take your Acyclovir 400 Stada® tablets more often or in larger doses). If you missed several doses, discuss with your doctor.

What should you bear in mind if you wish to interrupt or stop Acyclovir 400 Stada® early?

Even as your well-being may improve appreciably, you should complete Acyclovir 400 Stada® therapy as prescribed by your doctor so as not to jeopardise outcome.

Should you be in doubt – because of side effects for example – discuss with your doctor before interrupting or stopping treatment.

Side effects

What adverse reactions could you experience while using Acyclovir 400 Stada® ?

To date, Acyclovir 400 Stada® has occasionally been associated with the following side effects:

Skin rashes disappearing upon discontinuation of the medicinal product, gastro-intestinal symptoms including nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea, and abdominal pain. There have also been occasional reports of neurological (affecting the nervous system) side effects, mainly dizziness, confusion, hallucinations and drowsiness. These side effects disappeared upon discontinuation of the medicinal product and were typically seen in patients with impaired kidney function or other conditions pre-disposing to this sort of adverse reactions.

Moreover, there have been isolated reports or depersonalisation experiences disappearing upon discontinuation of the medicinal product. Transient convulsions and psychoses have need observed, especially with acyclovir administered by intravenous infusion to patients with complicated clinical courses.

There have been rare reports of transient laboratory adverse effects relating to liver and kidney function as well as the blood (bilirubin, liver enzyme, serum urea nitrogen and/or serum creatinine elevations, and/or serum creatinine elevations, and/or slight reductions in haematological parameters). There have also been rare reports of head-ache, exhaustion, insomnia or fatigue.

The rare patient has experienced difficulty breathing. There have been occasional reports of diffuse loss of hair associated with the use of Acyclovir 400 Stada®, but a causal relationship is unclear.

Should you experience any adverse effects not described in this insert, please be sure to inform your doctor or pharmacist.

Shelf life and stability of this medicine

The expiry date of this medicinal product is shown on the box and blister foil. Do not use this product after this expiry date.

Do not store above 30°C

Keep drugs out of reach of children

ACY400-01/9909
I9654



Produkt/Product: **ACYCLOVIR 400MG TAB SD MY:PIL**

STADA Mat.-Nr./Mat.-No.: **9299558 DZ: 2012**

STADA Art.-Nr./Art.-No.: **168060**

Hersteller/Manufacturer: **STADA AG**

Hersteller Art.-Nr./ Manufacturer Art.-No.: -

Format/Size: **148 x 420 mm**

Schriftgröße/Font-size: **7 pt - 13 pt**

PZN/EAN: -

Pharma-Code: **116**

Flattermarke/Collating mark: -

1. Farbe/Colour:  **Black**

2. Farbe/Colour: -

3. Farbe/Colour: -

4. Farbe/Colour: -

5. Farbe/Colour: -

6. Farbe/Colour: -

7. Farbe/Colour: -

8. Farbe/Colour: -

Version: **2. Loop** Datum/Date: **02.02.2021**

Agentur/Agency: **STADA Agency**

Grafik erstellt von/Graphic made by: **N.V.**

Aktueller Umlauf/Current loop: **N.V.**

Genehmigt/Approved

9299558
2012 MY